continued to serve the route or not. The traders, on their part, were planning to acquire their own ships.

It appears that the imbroglio continued with further extension of time served on the Swadeshi firm. By 16 October, the Swadeshi Steam Navigation Company had been registered (as narrated in the next chapter). Though the 'syndicate' transitioned into a registered, joint-stock company with limited liability, it is not clear if this had anything to do with the disagreements.

Meanwhile, more details emerged in a statement signed by 'S.V.' (evidently S.V. Nallaperumal Pillai), that listed the terms of the new agreement.[41] Shah Line Company had served a twenty-four-hour notice on the Swadeshi firm through its Tuticorin agent, Chinnathamby Machado. Before *Shah Allum* had arrived, the Swadeshi firm claimed that its representative Muhammed Bhai had clarified that the agreement would bind only those merchants who signed it. If, however, the Shah Line Company was able to convince other merchants to follow suit, they would be welcome. The key clauses were: (i) The renewed agreement would continue for a year; when, at any point in time after six months, the Swadeshi firm's own ship(s) arrived, it would cease employing Shah Line's steamers; (ii) Shah Line Company would offer a commission of 1.5 per cent of the entire revenue on passenger fares and freight; (iii) If a signatory to the agreement shipped on any other steamer, it would compensate the Shah Line Company by paying Rs 500 per month during the remaining duration of the term of agreement; if, on the other hand, its steamers ceased to operate, the Shah Line Company would offer a similar amount as compensation. However, S.V. contended that, when, on 13 November, Shah Line's Alibhai Adamjibhai and Sons and Chinnathamby Machado presented a new draft agreement, the terms were contrary to what had been agreed upon. Regarding clause (i), six months had been changed to one year (here, S.V. reminded Shah Line Company that this clause had been debated extensively and the Swadeshi concern had insisted on the option of closing the agreement any time after six months when the Swadeshis would acquire a new steamer); regarding clause (ii), the rate of commission had been